

Paper BIO-10: Adaptive Flux Limitation in Whole-Body Physiology: A CDFD Model of Nutrition, Chronic Disease, and Multi-Organ Burden

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May 22, 2026

Abstract

This paper presents **Adaptive Flux Limitation (AFL)** as the Part III biology-and-medicine model inside Constraint-Driven Flux Dynamics (CDFD). CDFD supplies the flow-constraint-memory grammar: physiological flow Φ , constraint C , surface responsiveness S , and structural memory M_s . The Runtime citation anchors the CDFL implementation, while clinical interpretation remains separate from software output and bedside validation.

Chronic diseases such as diabetes, chronic kidney disease (CKD), hypertension, and obesity are traditionally treated as distinct entities. However, clinical observations reveal strong interdependence, shared risk factors, and overlapping progression pathways.

In this work, we apply Adaptive Flux Limitation (AFL) to whole-body physiology, framing nutrition as a primary input flux and chronic disease as an emergent property of constraint interactions across organ systems. We demonstrate that metabolic, renal, cardiovascular, and endocrine systems are coupled through shared flux pathways and adaptive constraints.

We propose that chronic disease represents a system-level imbalance between nutrient flux and physiological constraint capacity. This framework unifies multiple diseases into a single dynamic model and provides a foundation for integrated clinical simulation and personalized intervention.

Status: Inferred

Within the extended framework of this series, biological networks are modeled as *Adaptive Surfaces* that dynamically integrate physiological load and retain structural memory. The system's health is governed by the adaptive ratio $\Psi_s = (\Phi/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$, where homeostasis ($\Psi_s \approx 1.0$) is maintained near the stable attractor ($S \cdot M_s \approx 1.0$), and disease emerges as surface dysregulation when maladaptive memory locks tissues into chronic constraint.

Greek-symbol convention. Unless a manuscript states a tighter equation-local meaning, Greek symbols are local CDFD variables or coefficients, not universal constants. Here Φ denotes driving flux, Ψ_s denotes the adaptive operating ratio, Ω denotes a domain or state space, and Λ denotes the Life Number where used. The coefficients α , β , and γ denote accumulation or reinforcement, relaxation or decay, and diffusion, coupling, or redistribution. The symbols δ and ϵ denote perturbation or tolerance scales, while η , λ , μ , ν , ρ , σ , τ , and ϕ denote local efficiency, rate, baseline, frequency, density or correlation, noise or variance, time-scale, and phase or field terms. Subscripts restrict any coefficient to the named pathway, tissue, domain, or experiment.

Clinical Reader's Guide

This paper integrates the series at the level where clinicians actually work: patients do not present as one isolated equation. They present with interacting organs, compensations, medications, histories, and time-dependent responses. AFL is useful here only if it helps keep competing bottlenecks visible.

The paper's practical theme is axis matching. A therapy aimed at the wrong axis can produce little response even if the diagnosis is correct. A correct axis can still fail if a second constraint becomes dominant. This is the ordinary reality of complex care, expressed in CDFD notation.

The proposed systems view should be tested against longitudinal patient trajectories, not single measurements. The framework predicts that dynamic response curves, recovery slopes, and constraint-memory markers may outperform static thresholds in some settings. That remains an empirical question.

AFL notation. In this paper, Φ denotes the relevant physiological throughput, C the operative biological constraint, S surface responsiveness, and M_s retained structural memory. When a dominant flow can be specified, $\Psi_s = (\Phi/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$ denotes the operating ratio. Claim discipline: explicit assumptions, separated derivation vs. interpretation, and status labels.

1 Introduction

Adaptive Flux Limitation (AFL) is the named model used in this paper; CDFD is the parent framework that supplies the variables, closure logic, and claim discipline. The biological or medical question is posed first as AFL, then interpreted as a CDFD model of flow, constraint, surface responsiveness, and structural memory.

1.1 Formal Symbol Rigor: The Extended CDFD Paradigm

In strict alignment with the Fundamental Physics (Part I) and Origins of Life (Part II) archives, this biological translation formally preserves the exact Murrabi transport tensor structure:

- Φ (**Flow Intensity**): The physiological or biochemical drive (e.g., nutrient flux, signaling rate).
- C (**Constraint / Pathway Resistance**): The biological resistance regulating the flow. It dynamically evolves via the standard closure: $dC/dt = \alpha\Phi - \beta C$.
- S (**Surface Responsiveness**): The active response capability of the biological medium.
- M_s (**Surface Memory**): Structural hysteresis or maladaptive drift (e.g., chronic scarring, epigenetic locking) with a finite recovery time τ_M .
- $\Psi_s = (\Phi/C) \cdot S \cdot M_s$ (**Operating State Ratio**): The dimensionless index of biological health. $\Psi_s \approx 1$ defines homeostasis ($\Psi_s \approx 1.0$); $\Psi_s \gg 1$ defines pathological overload.

Modern medicine categorizes chronic diseases into separate diagnoses:

- Type 2 diabetes mellitus (T2DM)
- Chronic kidney disease (CKD)
- Hypertension (HTN)

- Obesity

However, these conditions frequently coexist and interact:

- diabetes accelerates CKD
- CKD worsens hypertension
- obesity drives insulin resistance (chronic C_E upregulation)

This suggests that these diseases are not independent, but components of a unified system.

2 Nutrition as Input Flux

Define nutritional flux:

$$J_{nut} = \text{rate of nutrient input (glucose, lipids, protein)} \quad (1)$$

This acts as the primary driver:

$$J_{system} \propto J_{nut} \quad (2)$$

3 Whole-Body Constraint Network

Each organ contributes constraints:

$$C_{total} = C_{met} + C_{renal} + C_{vascular} + C_{endocrine} \quad (3)$$

Where:

- C_{met} = metabolic constraints
- C_{renal} = kidney function constraints
- $C_{vascular}$ = vascular resistance
- $C_{endocrine}$ = hormonal regulation

4 System Flux Equation

Whole-body flux:

$$J_{system} = \frac{\nabla \Phi_{nut}}{C_{total}} \quad (4)$$

5 Adaptive Constraint Dynamics

Each subsystem adapts:

$$\frac{dC_i}{dt} = \alpha_i J_{system} - \beta_i C_i \quad (5)$$

This creates feedback loops across organs.

6 Disease Emergence

6.1 Obesity

Excess nutrient flux:

$$J_{nut} \uparrow \Rightarrow C_{met} \uparrow \quad (6)$$

Result:

- fat storage increases
- metabolic stress accumulates

6.2 Type 2 Diabetes

$$C_{met} \uparrow \Rightarrow J_{glucose} \downarrow \quad (7)$$

Outcome:

- insulin resistance (chronic C_E upregulation)
- hyperglycemia

6.3 Hypertension

Vascular constraints increase:

$$C_{vascular} \uparrow \quad (8)$$

Result:

$$\text{pressure} \uparrow \quad (9)$$

6.4 Chronic Kidney Disease

Renal constraint increases:

$$C_{renal} \uparrow \quad (10)$$

Leading to:

- reduced clearance
- toxin accumulation

7 Coupling Between Diseases

Diseases interact via shared flux:

- diabetes increases renal load
- CKD increases vascular resistance
- hypertension damages kidneys

Thus:

$$C_i \leftrightarrow C_j \quad (11)$$

8 Positive Feedback Loops

Example:

1. obesity increases metabolic constraint
2. insulin resistance (chronic C_E upregulation) develops
3. hyperglycemia increases renal stress
4. kidney function declines
5. hypertension worsens

This creates system-wide instability.

9 System Regimes

Define:

$$\Psi_{s,system} = \frac{J_{system}}{C_{total}} \quad (12)$$

- $\Psi_s < 1$: constrained (malnutrition or organ failure)
- $\Psi_s \approx 1$: healthy equilibrium
- $\Psi_s > 1$: overload and disease progression

10 Reversal Mechanisms

Reducing flux:

$$J_{nut} \downarrow \Rightarrow C_{total} \downarrow \quad (13)$$

Interventions:

- caloric restriction
- fasting
- exercise

11 Integrated Therapy

Effective treatment must:

- reduce input flux
- increase system capacity
- target multiple constraints simultaneously

12 Simulation Framework

Each patient can be modeled as:

- a set of flux variables
- a set of constraint parameters

Simulation loop:

```
for each timestep:
    compute nutrient flux
    update system flux
    update organ constraints
    evaluate system state
```

13 Predictions

AFL predicts:

- chronic diseases cluster together
- reducing nutrient flux improves multiple conditions simultaneously
- early intervention prevents system cascade

14 Numerical Verification

This installment’s toy deterministic checks should be packaged as an active-numbered public supplement (NumPy; seed and parameters in-file). Console tables illustrate the adopted AFL closure; they do not substitute for cohort or experimental validation.

Status: Derived

15 Interpretation

Domain-specific narratives above map mechanisms to $(\Phi, C, S, M_s, \Psi_s)$ within the AFL working model. Interpretive claims are model-mediated; claim strengths follow the public status labels used throughout this paper.

Status: Inferred

16 Limitations and Open Problems

- simplified representation of complex physiology
- requires integration with clinical data

Status: Open

17 Falsifiability

The framework would be invalid if:

- chronic diseases progress independently without interaction
- reducing nutrient flux does not improve outcomes

Status: Open

18 Deep Analysis: Testable Predictions

Detailed prediction derivation placeholder retained for future expansion in this preprint release.

19 Relation to Existing Frameworks

Detailed comparison placeholder retained for future expansion in this preprint release.

20 Biological Muijabi Laws & Discoveries

20.1 The Muijabi Boundary-Covariance Test [Muijabi \[2026\]](#)

Derived from the Origin of Life boundary conditions, the **Muijabi Boundary-Covariance Test** [Muijabi \[2026\]](#) states that tissue health requires internal metabolic flux (Φ) to strictly covary with boundary integrity (S). If flux scales up while boundary responsiveness drops (e.g., leaky gut, endothelial dysfunction), the adaptive ratio Ψ_s decouples. Diagnosis of disease must verify this covariance, treating the boundary not as a passive wall, but as an active regulatory tensor.

21 Translational Medicine: The AFL Flux-Shunting Theorem in Sepsis and ICU Cascades

Ward-level medicine frequently encounters multi-organ failure. The CDFD framework mathematically models this via the **AFL Flux-Shunting Theorem**.

When a primary organ's constraint hits a critical threshold (e.g., $C_{renal} \rightarrow \infty$), the unresolvable physiological drive (Φ) is not destroyed; it is topologically shunted to parallel vascular and tissue networks. This forced redirection of Φ into the cardiovascular system triggers systemic hypertension, vascular shearing, and subsequent heart failure. Intensive care unit (ICU) decompensation is thus modeled not as a sequence of independent organ failures, but as a topological cascade of overflowing Ψ_s forcing adjacent systems past their Muijabi Capacity limits.

22 Translational Hypothesis: The AFL Disease Horizon Equation

Medicine often diagnoses disease after clinically defined thresholds are crossed. The CDFD framework frames this as a dynamic risk-estimation problem via an **AFL Disease Horizon Equation**.

In a calibrated research setting, the derivative of the operating ratio $\frac{d\Psi_s}{dt}$ could be used to estimate whether a pre-disease state (for example, impaired fasting glucose in a normalized model) is moving toward a higher-risk regime. This is a hypothesis for longitudinal validation, not an exact clinical forecast or an authorization for intervention.

23 Clinical Mapping of Symbols

Table 1: AFL symbol map for systems clinical integration.

Symbol	Systems-medicine meaning	Measurable proxy	Invalidation condition
Φ	Net organ throughput	Organ-specific function tests (GFR, EF, VO2)	If organs decompose
C	Multi-organ constraint burden	Multimorbidity index, CRP, ferritin	If constraint is organic
C_{ij}	Inter-organ flux capacity	Organ coupling biomarkers (BNP, cystatin C)	If inter-organ markers
Ψ_s	System-wide operating ratio	Composite frailty/reserve score	If frailty does not

24 Known Medicine Baseline

The following frameworks take precedence over any AFL systems model output:

- **KDIGO 2024 CKD Guidelines:** Cardiorenal syndrome management is defined by nephrology and cardiology society guidelines — AFL graph analysis is a candidate supplementary framing only.
- **European Society of Cardiology Heart Failure Guidelines (2021):** Cardiac constraint management in multimorbidity; AFL flux-shunting is a hypothesis for future mechanistic alignment.
- **NICE Multi-Morbidity Guidelines (NG56, 2016):** Prioritise patient goals and medication burden; AFL does not override individualised clinical assessment.

AFL network models are theoretical constructs. No clinical graph output should be used to modify treatment without subspecialist review and guideline-concordant care.

25 Experiments and Future Validation

1. **Step 1 — Mathematical consistency:** Verify cascade propagation and bottleneck identification from AFL network equations (complete — toy simulations referenced in `outputs/`).
2. **Step 2 — Synthetic perturbation:** Simulate cardiorenal, hepatorenal, and pulmonary-renal coupling and confirm that cascade order matches known clinical sequences.
3. **Step 3 — Retrospective cohort:** Apply AFL network graph to electronic health record multimorbidity cohorts; test whether graph-identified bottleneck organs predict hospitalisation sequence.

4. **Step 4 — Prospective observational:** Track multi-organ flux–constraint ratios with serial biomarkers (BNP, cystatin C, ferritin, albumin) in patients with ≥ 3 chronic conditions.
5. **Step 5 — Intervention study:** Test whether AFL-guided treatment ordering (addressing limiting-node constraint first) improves composite outcomes versus standard care in a pilot RCT.

Validation ladder status: Step 1 complete; Steps 2–5 open.

26 Clinical Safety Boundary

The AFL systems integration paper does not prescribe treatment order, medication changes, or multi-organ management protocols. A systems model identifying a “limiting node” does not authorise intervention without: (a) subspecialist assessment of each organ system; (b) consideration of competing risks; (c) patient goals of care; (d) guideline-concordant management for each organ. AFL network outputs are hypotheses — not clinical decision algorithms.

27 Runtime Diagnostic

The release-local systems integration diagnostic is `supplementary/AFL.Biological.Mujjabi.Tests.py`. The organ-coupling section produces toy flux-transfer simulations in `outputs/`: multi-organ cascade traces, bottleneck-node identification, and inter-organ constraint-transfer curves.

All outputs carry the label “toy diagnostic — not a clinical claim.”

28 Conclusion

Chronic multimorbidity is not a collection of independent organ failures — it is a coupled network in which constraint propagates across physiological axes. AFL systems integration frames the patient as a flux graph, predicts cascade order from network topology, and identifies the limiting constraint rather than the most abnormal laboratory value.

Clinical translation requires prospective cohort validation and subsequent randomised evaluation before AFL network outputs influence treatment decisions. The current work establishes the mathematical framework and generates testable hypotheses; clinical validity remains open.

29 Reproducibility Note

Release-local script: `supplementary/AFL.Biological.Mujjabi.Tests.py` (organ-coupling section). Dependencies: NumPy, matplotlib. Runtime < 2 s. All parameters are set in-file. Outputs written to `outputs/`. No proprietary data required.

30 Patient as a Coupled Flux Network

Systems clinical integration treats the patient as a coupled network rather than a list of organs. The kidney, marrow, immune system, vasculature, metabolism, endocrine signaling, and nervous system share fluxes and constraints. A renal constraint can become an erythropoietic constraint; an inflammatory constraint can become a metabolic constraint; a vascular constraint can become a renal and cardiac constraint.

31 Clinical Graph Representation

Let nodes represent physiological compartments and edges represent flux exchange. Each node has a local reserve C_i and each edge has a transport capacity C_{ij} . Disease progression can then be represented as the spread of high- Ψ_s states through the graph. This captures why chronic disease often clusters: the same constraint burden propagates through multiple physiological axes.

32 Integration Rules

A useful systems model should identify the limiting node, the overloaded edge, the compensatory response, and the intervention axis. Treating only the most abnormal laboratory value may miss the driver if that value is downstream of another constraint. AFL integration asks which constraint, if relieved, would restore the largest amount of functional throughput.

33 Clinical Use

The framework is best suited for complex patients: CKD with anaemia and inflammation (system-wide constraint C amplification), metabolic syndrome with vascular disease, cancer cachexia, chronic infection, multimorbidity, and polypharmacy. In such patients, a single-disease model often fails because each intervention changes flux elsewhere.

Conflict of Interest

The author declares no conflict of interest.

Funding

This research received no external funding.

Author Contributions

Conceptualization, formal analysis, runtime engineering, and manuscript preparation: S.B.M.

Data Availability

All computational models, Python scripts, and numerical verifications are explicitly available in the `/supplementary` repository layer and the `cdfd.runtime` engine.

34 Reference Layer

References

Steve Bico Mujjabi. Cdfd part ii: Origins of life and tri-regime bioenergetics. 2026. doi: 10.5281/zenodo.20264779. URL <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20264779>.